



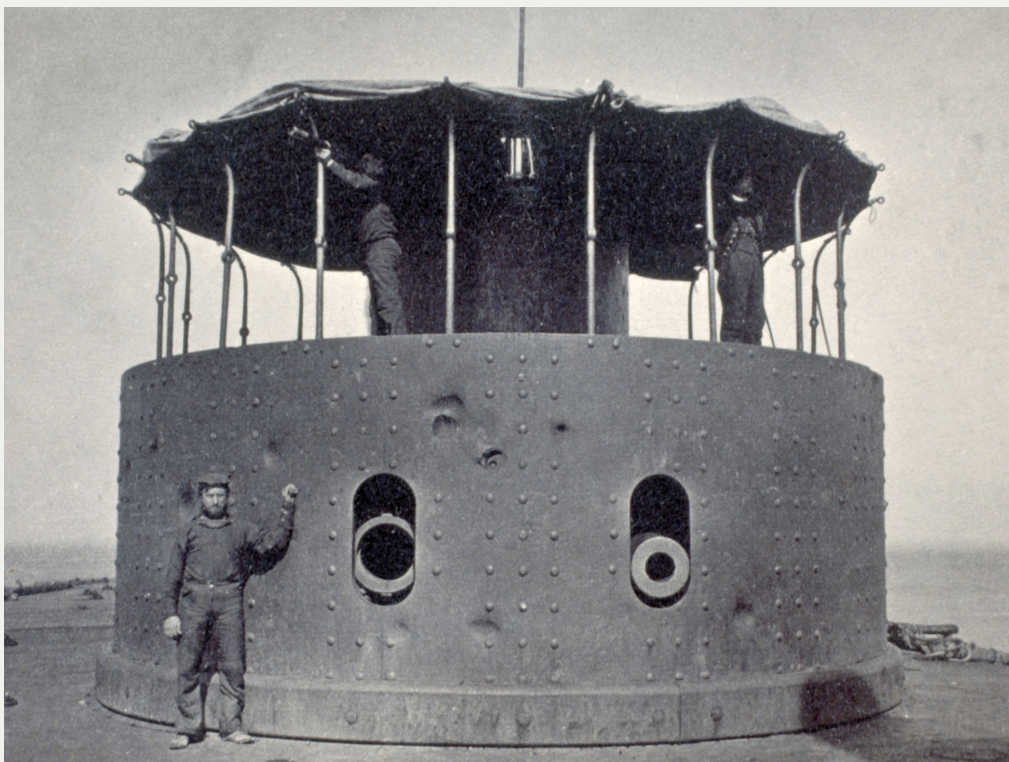
BEFORE

In the wake of Stonewall Jackson's death, Lee reorganized his army to prepare for an offensive thrust. The Union, meanwhile, was disheartened after repeated failures.

CONFEDERATE PROMOTIONS

Eager to reorganize the Army of Northern Virginia, **Lee abandoned the old system** of two wings led by two corps commanders. He recommended the **promotion of generals Richard Ewell and A. P. Hill** to corps command, with Ewell taking over most of Jackson's old force. Hill was to retain the rest, along with new troops gathered from other parts of Virginia and the Carolinas. Longstreet kept command of his corps, and became Lee's chief lieutenant.

NORTHERN DESPONDENCY



DAMAGED MONITOR TURRET

The North had little to celebrate in May and June of 1863. **Grant had yet to take Vicksburg**, and the first attempt to attack Charleston, South Carolina, ended in failure on April 7, when eight monitors were repulsed by Rebel guns at Fort Sumter. **Northern Copperheads (see "[Copperhead Democrats](#)") lamented that Confederate independence was near** and the time had come for negotiations with the South.

After the Battle of Chancellorsville, the South had the advantage. Now it was the turn of the Confederacy to decide where it would strike the Union army next rather than simply reacting to Northern advances. For the next few weeks, debates raged in the capital,